

RUH Airport Status

DISRUPTED

As of 12:56 PM, Saturday 10 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

151 flights cancelled today · last takeoff 12:52 PM · last landing 12:40 PM

Halt 6:37–8:08 AM (91 minutes) ended; traffic resumed. Cancellations remain elevated into Saturday afternoon. No official explanation for the morning stop.

HEADLINE

Morning halt 6:37–8:08 AM ended; traffic moving again; 151 flights cancelled today so far.

There were 21 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY349 to Hurgghada at 12:52 PM. The latest landing was F3204 from Tabuk at 12:40 PM, with 13 landings in the last hour. 151 flights are cancelled today (73 departures, 78 arrivals) and 3 arrivals have diverted. **Yesterday, 9 October:** 166 of 703 flights cancelled, 18 arrivals diverted and four halts of 45+ minutes, the longest 7:41 to 9:38 PM (no landing until 9:45 PM). No official reason has been given for the evening stop. **This morning:** a 91-minute halt ran from 6:37 to 8:08 AM with no takeoff or landing; traffic has since resumed. No official explanation. UAE carriers and now SriLankan Airlines are still cutting Riyadh; board cancellations remain elevated on Saturday.

151

FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY

73 departures + 78 arrivals, 20% of 769 scheduled.

12:52 PM

LAST TAKEOFF

XY349 to Hurgghada, 4 min before 12:56 PM.

12:40 PM

LAST LANDING

F3204 from Tabuk, 16 min before 12:56 PM.

21

TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR

13 landings in the last hour.

3

ARRIVALS DIVERTED

Mostly to Qassim, Dammam, MAA.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 12:56 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 151 (73 departures, 19%, 78 arrivals, 20%) at 12:57 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today	73 (19%)	78 (20%)	151	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled today, board count	73	78	151	FR24 boards, local day
Delayed today	115 (29%)	77 (20%)	192	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	21 (15%)	14 (15%)	35	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	28 min	56 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Disruption index (0–5)	3.05	5	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	134 of 196	92 of 163	226 of 359	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	3	3	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	11	17	28	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	75	96	171	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	60
flyadeal	17
Qatar Airways	8
Turkish Airlines	7
IndiGo	6

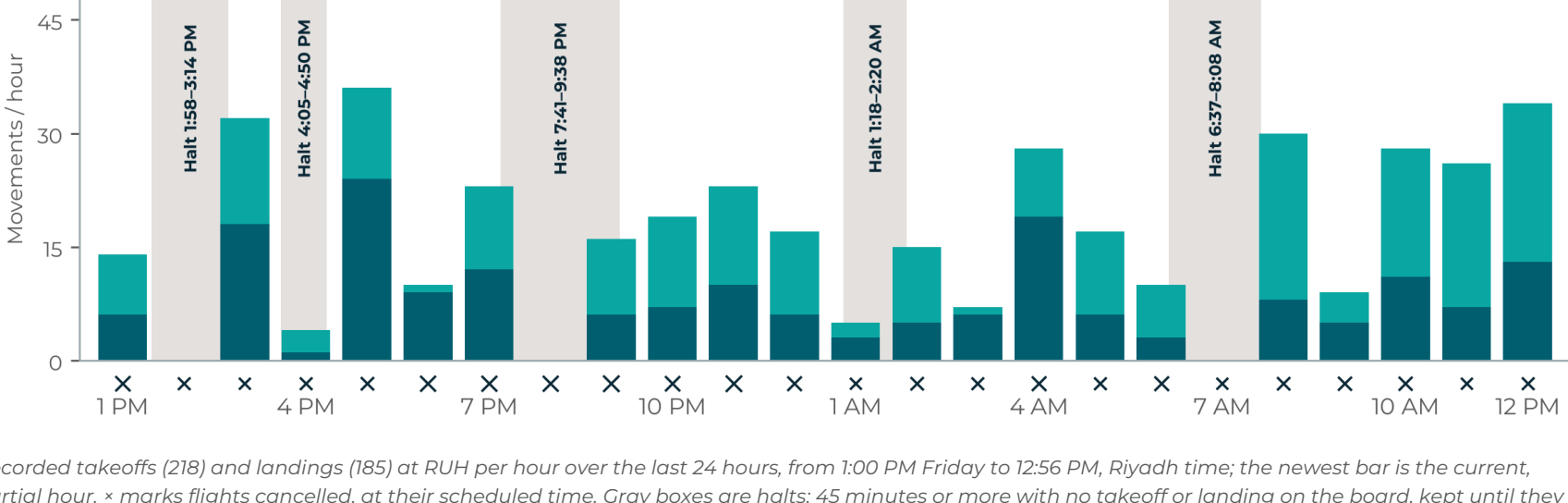
MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	25
Dubai	16
Istanbul	11
Dammam	10
Doha	8

Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport.json details/stats panel, fetched 12:57 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 12:56 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently, so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

1 AIRPORT FLOW, LAST 24 HOURS

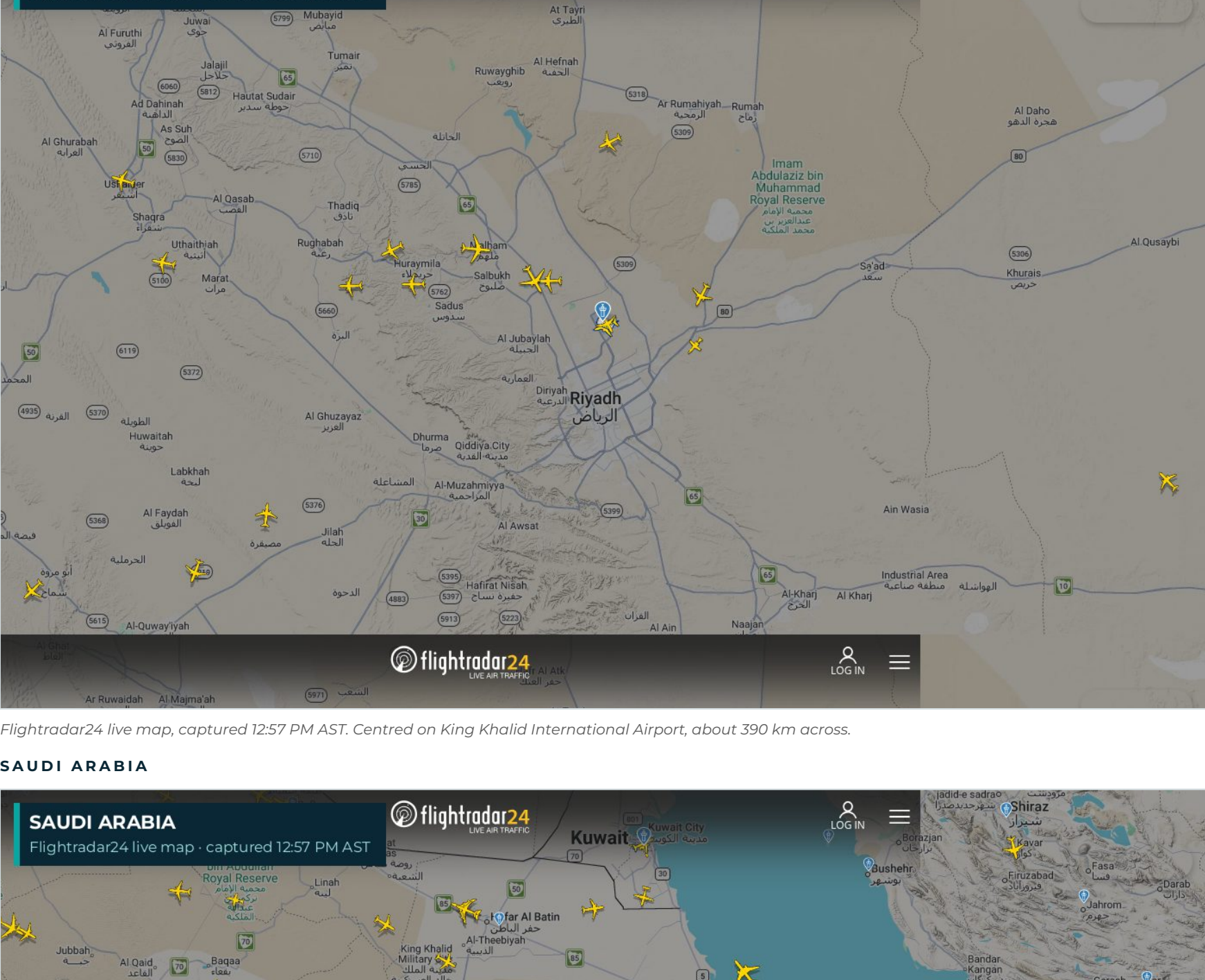
Takeoffs and landings per hour, last 24 hours to 12:56 PM.



Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): yesterday 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, 7:41–9:38 PM, overnight 1:18–2:20 AM, and this morning 6:37–8:08 AM.

2 AIRSPACE NOW

Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.



Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:57 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across.



Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:57 PM AST. Central and eastern Saudi Arabia, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast.

Read with care: the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

3 WATCHED GULF ROUTES

Next departures from RUH: 3 of 5 routes on schedule.

ROUTE	FLIGHT	AIRLINE	SCHEDULED	ESTIMATE	STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT	CANCELLED
Dubai (DXB)	XY205	flynas	1:05 PM	1:05 PM	On schedule	8
Bahrain (BAH)	SV520	Saudia	3:25 PM	3:25 PM	On schedule	0
Muscat (MCT)	WY684	Oman Air	4:05 PM	4:05 PM	On schedule	2
Abu Dhabi (AUH)	EY556	Etihad Airways	4:45 PM	5:00 PM	Delayed	1
Doha (DOH)	QR8731	Qatar Airways	11:45 AM	—	Has not left yet	5

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 12:56 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight itself: on schedule = no later estimate; Delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include: Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR1241, QR1169, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Etihad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; Salamair OV206 to Muscat.

4 NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Morning halt 6:37–8:08 AM ended with no official word; SriLankan suspends Riyadh until 18 Oct; UAE carriers still cutting Saturday; state media says Friday flow was smooth.

Checked at 12:55 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED SriLankan Airlines suspends all Riyadh flights until 18 October

Aviation Voice / The Morning · 12:20 PM · published ~12:20 PM AST (Aviation Voice / The Morning 10 Oct); last checked 12:55 PM

Aviation Voice and The Morning report SriLankan Airlines has temporarily suspended all flights to Riyadh until 18 October 2026 after the security incident at King Khalid airport, citing ongoing safety and operational assessments. The airline said services will resume once conditions are considered suitable. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED UAE Vartha: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancel UAE–Riyadh services

Saudi Vartha · 11:00 AM · published 10 Oct 2026 (UAE Vartha); last checked 12:55 PM

UAE Vartha reports Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancelled multiple UAE–Riyadh services on Saturday, citing operational disruption at King Khalid airport, with spillover cancellations to Abha and Yanbu. Etihad grounded EY551/EY558 and EY552/EY556 while keeping EY559/EY560; Emirates cancelled EK815/EK819 and EK816/EK818/EK820; flydubai scrubbed FZ847/FZ841/FZ855 and FZ848/FZ842/FZ856; Air Arabia cancelled Sharjah–Riyadh and Abha rotations. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED Gulf News: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday

Gulf News · 9:21 AM · published 9:21 AM AST (Gulf News 10:21 AM GST); last checked 12:55 PM

Gulf News reports travellers from the UAE and Riyadh still face cancellations on Saturday from Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia. flydubai lists Riyadh and Yanbu cancellations through 10 October and Abha through 11 October; Etihad cites operational disruption at Riyadh airport. Flightradar24 board figures in this edition are the live totals.

CONFIRMED Anadolu / Alekhbariya: passenger flow at RUH described as smooth after Thursday attacks

Anadolu Agency / News.az · 10:10 AM · published ~10:10 AM (News.az / Anadolu dated 10 Oct); last checked 12:55 PM

Anadolu Agency, citing Saudi state TV Alekhbariya, says passenger movement at King Khalid airport was flowing smoothly and air traffic returned to normal on Friday after the Thursday attacks that killed three Saudi citizens. GACA had said operations resumed Friday. This edition's board still shows elevated Saturday cancellations and airline suspensions; no official comment on this morning's 6:37–8:08 AM halt.

CONFIRMED PIA suspends Riyadh flights; Lufthansa, Etihad and flydubai cuts continue

Dawn · 4:43 AM · published 4:43 AM (Dawn updated); last checked 12:55 PM

Dawn reports Pakistan International Airlines temporarily suspended flights to Riyadh, citing the Middle East situation. The same roundup notes Lufthansa Group suspended Riyadh services until 16 October, Etihad cancelled further Abu Dhabi–Riyadh flights earlier, and flydubai cancelled Riyadh and Yanbu through 10 October. Flightradar24 figures cited there are earlier; see this edition's board totals for today.

UNVERIFIED Social posts claim a Ugandan national was killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport

Unverified accounts on X · 7:45 AM · published ~7:45 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Accounts on X name Ugandan bus driver Muwenda Edward as killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport. GACA's confirmed fatality count remains three Saudi citizens from the 8 October attacks; no official confirmation of this additional name as of this check.

CONFIRMED Arab News Japan: widespread condemnation of Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport

Arab News Japan on X · 10:30 AM · published 10:30 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Arab News Japan notes strong and widespread condemnation on Friday of the Houthi attacks targeting King Khalid airport, with statements reiterating solidarity with the Kingdom. No new RUH operational figures in the post.

CONFIRMED Saudi Gazette: coalition destroyed 136 Houthi military targets

Saudi Gazette on X · 5:35 AM · published 5:35 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

Saudi Gazette reports the coalition announced a large-scale operation against the Houthis, destroying 136 military targets in areas under the group's control. No RUH operational information and no official comment on overnight or morning airport disruption.

CONFIRMED UAE Foreign Ministry condemns Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport and Saudia aircraft

UAE MoFA / Khaleej Times · 10:06 AM · MoFA statement circulated overnight; Khaleej Times post ~10:06 AM; last checked 12:55 PM

UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs strongly condemned Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport and a Saudia aircraft. Khaleej Times and the UAE Embassy in KSA amplified the statement. No RUH operational information.

5 METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

• Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf routes, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards fetched at 12:56 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airports feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.

• The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.

• Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
12:56 PM, Sat 10 Oct	12:56 PM	Flightradar24, Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Dawn, Gulf News	Disrupted	Open sources · not official	1:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24 (boards, airport stats, X), Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 1:00 PM